

Cecile, you helped build families where there were only hopes and dreams, guiding so many through the journey of international adoption with compassion, strength, and grace. Your legacy lives on in every child held, in every family you helped create including your own. Your heart touched so many lives - and your light will never fade. We were lucky to have met you and we will miss you deeply.

Orietta, Michele & Nicole

Cecile was one of the first people I met when I started the adoption process. I was feeling overwhelmed by lots of paperwork, and too much reading on the topic - too many opinions and conflicting advice.

It was like wading through stew. Then I went to a day of talks Cecile had organised in London for would be adopters.

Her knowledge, enthusiasm and kindness gave me the positive lift I needed to continue. If she could do it, then so could I!

Once my son Roman was home with me, I phoned her for advice over several years. She always gave me her time generously. She listened and where possible, pointed me in the right direction for further help.

She was undoubtedly the expert on all things Russian adoption.

Underpinning all of this, and most importantly, was her own experience of adopting Sasha, becoming a mother to Sasha, and being brilliant at it. She gave Sasha a rich and textured childhood, was her no. 1 advocate, and fought hard to get the things in place Sasha needed to thrive.

Sasha, I don't know you, but please accept my deepest condolences. Your Mum was a pioneer, strong and resilient. We all benefitted from her wisdom. That is no consolation for a life cut short so unexpectedly. As you go on through your own life, I hope that you will feel her strength and kindness in you.

Tracy Jeune x